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mobile data. When on Wi-Fi, carriers in developing countries find it hard to capture the mobile number, and thus they found that 30 to 45 per cent of transactions were failing. That's a huge loss for telcos and a huge source of frustration to users like us who wouldn't understand why transactions failed. B Sekhar Rao, founder and CEO JunoTele says, "No payment gateway in the world (Credit cards, wallets, PayPal, carrier billing etc) has the ability to authenticate the validity of the mobile user or the transaction without the availability of an active data connection. JunoTele has the ability to do that as long as the voice network of the Mobile user is enabled. This opens up significant possibilities for any payment mechanism in the world to complete a transaction even in remote areas or data offline areas." Yes, you read that right, JunoTele figured out a way to even authenticate transactions where there is no data coverage at all!

CHANGE IS THE ONLY CONSTANT

Not everything will go as you want, and it's important that you realise that sometimes you have to look ahead and solve for problems that aren't even your fault to begin with. Or else, market scenarios might change overnight, and you will need to rethink strategies.

Eduator, a digital learning company that wants to educate India using tablets, and has already reached 40,000 students across India. Eduator's product is IGNITOR, and they work with principals, students, teachers, parents and even

publishers to try and make an enriching e-learning experience. They faced a lot of challenges though, especially with hardware. Tablets were either very expensive or very poor quality when IGNITOR was being developed, and they had to design it with very low processing power in mind. They also had to consider that most schools across India will have little or no IT infrastructure, and thus had to keep that in mind. Publishers are another problem, as they hate the digital medium, because of piracy, so a lot of time was spent on securing the content. Ram Gollamudi, CEO and Founder Eduator Technologies, is still thrilled with the possibilities, despite the hardships: "The current trend includes rapid innovation and lot of ideas on how to transform the antiquated education system in India with new tools and pedagogy styles. Exciting times ahead for Ed-tech 2.0 in India!"

Of course you could always startup a startup whose clients are startups, and thus have a startup in a startup-loving market that takes advantage of the startup boom! (That's about as many times we can say "startup" in a sentence and still make sense...)

We're talking of Talent Pad, a job marketplace for both recruiters and candidates that's aimed specifically at technology jobs. Why? Because all startups today need good resources (especially after a round of funding) and that means that technology and product management personnel are always in short supply. So what does Talent Pad do? It curates thousands of CVs, short-



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lists the cream of the crop (roughly 10 per cent) and finds them job offers from a range of companies. Most job portals are targeted at keeping the recruiter happy, but Talent Pad gives both equal importance. The candidate chooses which offers he or she wants to consider, and then Talent Pad lines up interviews. Over 6,000 interview job offers have been made to candidates, worth over 1000+ crore (in salaries) by over 200 companies. Says Mayank Jain, CEO and Co-founder Talent Pad, "The current trends in the market reflect on the talent supply gap and a shift of power towards candidates rather than the recruiters. Factors such as competition of talent between firms, premium talent having multiple options and most importantly the change in approach towards job search by candidates who are giving preference to personal growth rather than hefty salaries are some of the trends driving today's job market. We understand this demand, and have customised our platform to address the need for a robust, premium, transparent recruitment platform."

GET STARTED

So what are you waiting for? Quickly finish reading the rest of this cover story and get started on your startup. Fortune favours the brave and all that... Remember to write in to us (editor@digit.in) as well, and give us feedback, tell us about your startup idea, or lament with us, if you, like us, have had wonderful ideas before someone else implemented it. <insert sad smiley here>. 



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